

Πλάτων ὁ Ἀθηναῖος

Plato of Athens and the Dialogues

eul_aid: ffk

Period: [Κλασική](#) [Classical](#)
Dialect: [Φιλοσοφική Ἀττική](#) [Attic](#) [Philosophical](#)
Domain: [Φιλοσοφία](#) [Philosophy](#)
Format: [Διάλογος](#) [Dialogue](#)
Affiliation: [Platonist](#)

Plato was a philosopher from Athens who lived during the 5th and 4th centuries BCE, from approximately 428 to 348 BCE. He was born into an aristocratic Athenian family and came of age during the turbulent end of the Peloponnesian War. The execution of his teacher, Socrates, in 399 BCE deeply affected him and turned him toward a life of philosophy.

After traveling, he founded the Academy in Athens around 387 BCE, an institution dedicated to teaching and research that is often considered the first European university. Later in life, he traveled to Sicily in an unsuccessful attempt to advise a ruler there, an experience that reflected his political ideals.

Plato's surviving works are almost all written as philosophical dialogues, with Socrates frequently appearing as the main speaker. Scholars traditionally group over thirty of these dialogues into early, middle, and late periods of his career. Among his most famous works are the Republic, which explores justice and proposes rule by philosopher-kings; the Symposium, which discusses the nature of love; and the Timaeus, which presents a cosmological account of the universe. All his major dialogues survive complete.

Plato is a foundational figure in Western thought. His establishment of the Academy created a lasting model for philosophical schools. Through his dialogues, he defined core areas of philosophy, including ethics, politics, metaphysics, and epistemology. Central ideas attributed to his philosophy include the Theory of Forms, which suggests that perfect, non-physical realities underlie the visible world, and the belief that the soul is immortal. His literary skill made complex ideas engaging and accessible. His work was the primary influence on the later tradition of Platonism and, through its engagement with Christian theology, profoundly shaped the intellectual history of Europe.

Works (41)

- [Ἀλκιβιάδης α'](#) · [Alcibiades A](#) · 903 passages
- [Ἀλκιβιάδης β'](#) · [Alcibiades B](#) · 181 passages
- [Ἀπολογία Σωκράτους](#) · [Apology of Socrates](#) · 113 passages
- [Χαρμίδης](#) · [Charmides](#) · 114 passages
- [Κλειτοφῶν](#) · [Clitophon](#) · 4 passages
- [Κλειτοφῶν](#) · [Clitophon](#) · 4 passages
- [Κρατύλος](#) · [Cratylus](#) · 761 passages
- [Κριτίας](#) · [Critias](#) · 5 passages

- [Κρίτων · Crito](#) · 95 passages
- [Ὅροι · Definitions](#) · 26 passages
- [Ἐπιγράμματα · Epigrams \(Anthologia Graeca Selection\)](#) · 93 passages
- [Ἐπιγράμματα · Epigrams \(with Anacreontea\)](#) · 33 passages
- [Ἐπινομίς · Epinomis](#) · 28 passages
- [Εὐθύδημος · Euthydemus](#) · 67 passages
- [Εὐθύφρων · Euthyphro](#) · 232 passages
- [Γοργίας · Gorgias](#) · 1071 passages
- [Ἰππίας μείζων · Greater Hippias](#) · 355 passages
- [Ἱππαρχος · Hipparchus](#) · 161 passages
- [Ἴων · Ion](#) · 164 passages
- [Λάχης · Laches](#) · 254 passages
- [Νόμοι · Laws](#) · 1795 passages
- [Ἰππίας ἐλάττων · Lesser Hippias](#) · 229 passages
- [Ἐρασταί · Lovers](#) · 32 passages
- [Λύσις · Lysis](#) · 2 passages
- [Μενέξενος · Menexenus](#) · 33 passages
- [Μένων · Meno](#) · 561 passages
- [Μίνως · Minos](#) · 188 passages
- [Παρμενίδης · Parmenides](#) · 2 passages
- [Φαίδων · Phaedo](#) · 34 passages
- [Φαίδρος · Phaedrux](#) · 373 passages
- [Φίληβος · Philebus](#) · 1140 passages
- [Ἐπιστολαί · Plato's Political Letters](#) · 240 passages
- [Πρωταγόρας · Protagoras](#) · 23 passages
- [Πολιτεία · Republic](#) · 1221 passages
- [Σοφιστής · Sophist](#) · 1176 passages
- [Νόθοι · Spurious](#) · 112 passages
- [Πολιτικός · Statesman](#) · 891 passages
- [Συμπόσιον · Symposium](#) · 5 passages
- [Θεαίτητος · Theaetetus](#) · 1019 passages
- [Θεάγης · Theages](#) · 135 passages
- [Τίμαιος · Timaeus](#) · 41 passages

Other Platonist Authors

- [Ἀλβίνος ὁ Πλατωνικός · Albinus the Platonist](#) · 2 works
- [Ἀλέξανδρος Λυκοπολίτης · Alexander of Lycopolis](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀνώνυμος ὑπόμνημα εἰς τὸν Πλάτωνος Θεαίτητον · Anonymous Commentary on Plato](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀρίμνηστος · Arimnestus the Philosopher](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀττικός · Atticus the Philosopher](#) · 1 work
- [Κάσσιος Λογγίνος · Cassius Longinus the Philosopher](#) · 3 works
- [Κέλσος ὁ Πλατωνικός · Celsus the Platonist](#) · 1 work
- [Κράντωρ ὁ Σολεύς · Crantor of Soli](#) · 2 works

- Εὐδρόμος · Eudromus the Philosopher · 1 work
- Ἡρακλείδης ὁ Ποντικός · Heraclides of Pontus · 2 works
- Ἡρακλείδης ὁ Ποντικός · Heraclides of Pontus II · 1 work
- Ἡρακλείδης ὁ Ποντικός · Heraclides of Pontus III · 1 work